

D628

Public Health Graduate Capstone

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A graduate student who grew up in a coastal town with a well-known seafood festival wants to improve health there. She already likes a walking-club program she read about. Her advisor has published widely on nutrition. What should she do first?

- A. Write the outcome evaluation plan before anything else
- B. Launch the walking club and measure participation
- C. Conduct a community needs assessment using local data to identify and prioritize the problem
- D. Focus on nutrition because her advisor is an expert in it

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

A health department in a county known for its apple orchards reviews state BRFSS survey results on adult smoking for its county. It also runs six focus groups with young adults at the local community college. Staff salaries were recently frozen. Which source is primary data?

- A. Both, because any data the department analyzes becomes primary
- B. The six focus groups
- C. Neither, because focus groups are qualitative
- D. The BRFSS results, because they are the main state source

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A program in a neighborhood with three new charter schools holds 24 cooking classes and reaches 310 parents, supported by \$45,000 from a regional foundation. In a logic model, “24 classes held and 310 parents reached” is which component?

- A. Outputs
- B. Short-term outcomes
- C. Inputs, because the foundation money funds the classes
- D. Long-term impact

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

In logic-model terms, which of these is a short-term outcome of a parent cooking-class program?

- A.** Lower neighborhood hypertension rates ten years later
- B.** The grant and staff time used to run the classes
- C.** Parents' improved skill at cooking low-sodium meals on a pre/post test
- D.** The number of classes held

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

Midway through a school hand-washing program in a district that recently changed superintendents, staff check whether each classroom delivered all five lessons as planned and how many students attended. District enrollment is 12,000. What type of evaluation is this?

- A.** Outcome evaluation, because attendance is counted
- B.** Impact evaluation, since any evaluation that uses numbers measures impact
- C.** Formative evaluation, because it happens midway
- D.** Process evaluation

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Before launch, a team shows draft brochures to eight community members to check whether the wording is clear and culturally fitting. Which type of evaluation is this?

- A.** Outcome evaluation
- B.** Process evaluation
- C.** No evaluation at all, since pilots never count
- D.** Formative evaluation

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A capstone team designing a diabetes prevention program for a neighborhood with a large weekend farmers market plans to present the finished program to community leaders for approval at the end. The team has a strong statistics background. What is the best change to the plan?

- A. Involve community members and leaders from the start in defining needs and shaping the program
- B. Keep the plan, since experts design and communities approve
- C. Translate the finished materials into the main languages spoken
- D. Use the team’s statistics to prove the need so buy-in is unnecessary

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

An agency in a rural region with long winters adopts an evidence-based diabetes prevention program with 16 core sessions. Its board chair owns a local radio station. Staff time is tight. Which change best keeps the program effective?

- A. Make no changes at all, because any adaptation voids the evidence
- B. Cut the program to 8 sessions to save staff time
- C. Keep all core sessions and content but change examples, foods, and meeting places to fit the community
- D. Replace half the sessions with radio ads on the board chair’s station

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A health educator at a county agency that recently moved into a new building writes this objective: “Increase fruit and vegetable intake among adults in the county.” The agency’s annual report won a design award. What does the objective most need?

- A. A stronger verb such as “dramatically increase”
- B. A baseline, a target amount, and a deadline, such as from 20% to 30% of adults by December 2028
- C. A list of activities such as cooking demonstrations
- D. A note naming the new building as the program site

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

An objective sets a target that is a 25% relative increase over a baseline flu-shot rate of 40% of adults. What is the target rate?

- A. 50%
- B. 65%
- C. 30%
- D. 25%

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A smoking-cessation program in a mid-sized city that just opened a light-rail line cost \$60,000 and enrolled 400 participants. At six months, 120 were tobacco-free. The program director has 20 years of experience. What is the cost per participant who quit?

- A. \$214
- B. 30%
- C. \$150
- D. \$500

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A funder will pay no more than \$400 per participant who quits. A program costs \$50,000 and expects 25% of enrollees to quit. What is the minimum enrollment needed to meet the funder's limit?

- A. 167
- B. 500
- C. 125
- D. 31

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

A graduate student who grew up in a coastal town ~~with a well-known seafood festival~~ wants to improve health there. She already likes a walking-club program she read about. ~~Her advisor has published widely on nutrition.~~ What should she do first?

Target word: first step **Decides:** Design begins with a data-based needs assessment.

A	Inverted operation	Evaluation is planned from objectives, which come after the need is known.
B	Dropped element	Skips the assessment step that justifies the program.
C	Correct	The need must be documented before an intervention is chosen.
D	Camouflage	The advisor's expertise does not establish the community's need.

2. Answer B Concept 2

A health department in a county ~~known for its apple orchards~~ reviews state BRFSS survey results on adult smoking for its county. It also runs six focus groups with young adults at the local community college. ~~Staff salaries were recently frozen.~~ Which source is primary data?

Target word: which source is primary **Decides:** Who collected it for this project.

A	Absolute language	Analyzing existing data does not make it primary.
B	Correct	The department collected them itself for this purpose.
C	Adjacent category	Qualitative vs. quantitative is a different dimension from primary vs. secondary.
D	Confusion set	BRFSS was collected by others for surveillance, so it is secondary here.

3. Answer A Concept 3

A program in a neighborhood ~~with three new charter schools~~ holds 24 cooking classes and reaches 310 parents, ~~supported by \$45,000 from a regional foundation.~~ In a logic model, "24 classes held and 310 parents reached" is which component?

Target word: logic-model component **Decides:** Counts of delivery and reach.

A	Correct	Counts of sessions delivered and people reached are outputs.
B	Confusion set	Outcomes are changes in the parents, not counts of classes.
C	Camouflage	The \$45,000 is an input, but the phrase asked about is a count of delivery.
D	Adjacent category	Impact is population-level change over years.

4. Answer C Concept 3 • transfer

In logic-model terms, which of these is a short-term outcome of a parent cooking-class program?

Target word: short-term outcome **Decides:** A change in the participants themselves soon after the program.

A	Adjacent category	That is long-term impact.
B	Inverted operation	Those are inputs, the opposite end of the model.
C	Correct	A near-term change in participant knowledge or skill is a short-term outcome.
D	Confusion set	That is an output.

5. Answer D Concept 4

Midway through a school hand-washing program in a district ~~that recently changed superintendents~~, staff check whether each classroom delivered all five lessons as planned and how many students attended. ~~District enrollment is 12,000.~~ What type of evaluation is this?

Target word: evaluation type **Decides:** Checking delivery as planned and reach.

A	Confusion set	Outcome evaluation measures changes such as fewer sick days.
B	Absolute language	Using numbers does not make an evaluation about impact.
C	Adjacent category	Formative evaluation tests materials or plans before full launch.
D	Correct	Checking delivery and attendance is process evaluation.

6. Answer D Concept 4 • transfer

Before launch, a team shows draft brochures to eight community members to check whether the wording is clear and culturally fitting. Which type of evaluation is this?

Target word: evaluation type **Decides:** Testing materials before launch.

A	Inverted operation	Outcome evaluation measures effects after the program, not before.
B	Confusion set	Process evaluation checks delivery after launch.
C	Absolute language	Pretesting is a standard form of evaluation.
D	Correct	Pretesting materials before launch is formative.

7. Answer A Concept 5

A capstone team designing a diabetes prevention program for a neighborhood ~~with a large weekend farmers market~~ plans to present the finished program to community leaders for approval at the end. ~~The team has a strong statistics background.~~ What is the best change to the plan?

Target word: best change **Decides:** Engagement must start early and continue.

A	Correct	Early, shared decision-making builds fit, trust, and buy-in.
B	Inverted operation	Reverses the participatory order the field recommends.
C	Dropped element	Useful, but drops the real fix of involving the community in design.
D	Camouflage	Strong data do not replace community engagement.

8. Answer C Concept 6

An agency in a rural region ~~with long winters~~ adopts an evidence-based diabetes prevention program with 16 core sessions. ~~Its board chair owns a local radio station.~~ Staff time is tight. Which change best keeps the program effective?

Target word: acceptable adaptation **Decides:** Core components must stay; surface features may change.

A	Absolute language	Surface adaptations are expected and encouraged.
B	Dropped element	Dropping core components removes what made it work.
C	Correct	Surface adaptation with core fidelity keeps the evidence base valid.
D	Camouflage	The board chair's station is irrelevant, and ads are not the tested sessions.

9. Answer B Concept 7

A health educator at a county agency ~~that recently moved into a new building~~ writes this objective: "Increase fruit and vegetable intake among adults in the county." ~~The agency's annual report won a design award.~~ What does the objective most need?

Target word: missing SMART elements **Decides:** No amount and no deadline.

A	Absolute language	Stronger words do not make it measurable.
B	Correct	Measurable and time-bound elements are missing.
C	Adjacent category	Activities describe how, not the measurable result.
D	Camouflage	The building is irrelevant to whether the objective is SMART.

10. Answer A Concept 7 • transfer

An objective sets a target that is a 25% relative increase over a baseline flu-shot rate of 40% of adults. What is the target rate?

Target word: target percentage **Decides:** $40\% \times 1.25$.

A	Correct	$40\% \times 1.25 = 50\%$.
B	Wrong stem number	Adds 25 percentage points instead of a 25% relative increase.
C	Inverted operation	Applies a 25% decrease instead of an increase.
D	Dropped element	Drops the baseline and reports the increase itself as the target.

11. Answer D Concept 8

A smoking-cessation program in a mid-sized city ~~that just opened a light rail line~~ cost \$60,000 and enrolled 400 participants. At six months, 120 were tobacco-free. ~~The program director has 20 years of experience.~~ What is the cost per participant who quit?

Target word: cost per quitter **Decides:** $\$60,000 \div 120$ quitters.

A	Inverted operation	Divides by the 280 who did not quit.
B	Adjacent category	That is the quit rate, an effectiveness measure, not a cost per outcome.
C	Wrong stem number	Divides by the 400 enrolled, not the 120 who quit.
D	Correct	$\$60,000 \div 120 = \500 per person who quit.

12. Answer B Concept 8 • transfer

A funder will pay no more than \$400 per participant who quits. A program costs \$50,000 and expects 25% of enrollees to quit. What is the minimum enrollment needed to meet the funder's limit?

Target word: minimum enrollment **Decides:** Need 125 quitters; $125 \div 0.25$.

A	Confusion set	Uses the 75% who do not quit instead of the 25% who do.
B	Correct	$\$50,000 \div \$400 = 125$ quitters needed; $125 \div 0.25 = 500$ enrollees.
C	Dropped element	Drops the quit rate; 125 is the number of quitters needed.
D	Inverted operation	Multiplies 125 by 0.25 instead of dividing.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	5	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	2	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	6	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	7	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	5	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	6	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	5	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Needs assessment comes first	Program design starts by documenting and prioritizing the community's need with data, before choosing an intervention.	Picking a favorite program and then looking for a problem it fits.	"What should the planner do first?"
2	Primary vs. secondary data	Primary data are collected by the team for this project; secondary data were collected by someone else for another purpose.	Calling data primary because it is the main source or because the team analyzes it.	Who collected the data and for what purpose.
3	Logic model components	Inputs are resources, activities are what the program does, outputs are counts of delivery, outcomes are changes in people, and impact is long-term population change.	Reporting outputs such as classes held as if they were outcomes.	A count of sessions or people reached versus a change in knowledge, behavior, or health.
4	Formative, process, and outcome evaluation	Formative evaluation tests materials before launch, process evaluation checks delivery and reach, and outcome evaluation measures effects.	Calling any mid-program measurement an outcome evaluation.	Whether the question is "Is it clear?", "Was it delivered?", or "Did it work?"
5	Community and stakeholder engagement	Involve the people affected and those with influence from the start, sharing decisions throughout design.	Designing the program with experts and asking the community to approve it at the end.	A plan that brings community members in only at the final presentation.
6	Fidelity and adaptation	Keep an evidence-based program's core components and adapt only surface features such as examples, language, and setting.	Cutting sessions or content to save time and still claiming the evidence applies.	A proposal to shorten or drop parts of a tested curriculum.
7	SMART objectives	An objective must be specific, measurable, achievable, relevant, and time-bound, with a baseline and a target value.	Writing a goal statement with no amount or deadline and calling it an objective.	An objective missing a number or a date.
8	Cost per outcome for justification	Cost per outcome equals total cost divided by the number of people who achieved the outcome, not the number enrolled.	Dividing by enrollment and presenting it as cost per success.	"Per participant who quit" or "per person who achieved".

Course scope (public description): Public Health Graduate Capstone enables students to investigate a public health issue in their local or home community and recommend new approaches to address that issue. Students practice the skills they have honed over the Master of Public Health program to design one that improves public health through education. Students control the process from research and discovery to program design, ultimately justifying their approach to potential stakeholders.